Bachelor Thesis

Meeting 2

Not a rule but suggested.
Directly affects a graded criterion.

General tips: Citations

Narrative citation:
- 2+ authors: Jones et al. (2026)
- 2 authors: Jones and Smith (2026)
- 1 author: Jones (2026)

Parenthetical citation:
- 2+ authors: (Jones et al., 2026)
- 2 authors: (Jones & Smith, 2026)
- 1 author: (Jones, 2026)

Make sure to format citations correctly!

Minimize the number of narrative citations, opt for parenthetical citations.
Authors should only be mentioned narratively if their work is integral part of your study, and you will be actively contributing to their ideas directly and/or when a paper is a foundational study.

Example

Smith et al. (2019) found that heart rate increases during social evaluation. Jansen and De Vries (2021) also found this, and Lee (2022) showed that the effect is stronger in people with high social anxiety.

What do we know?

Heart rate increases during social evaluation (Jansen & De Vries, 2021; Smith et al., 2019).
This effect is stronger in people with high social anxiety (Lee, 2022).

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General tips: Abbreviations

Abbreviations:
- attention-deficit hyperactivity disorder **(ADHD)**
- World Health Organization **(WHO)**
- reaction time **(RT)**...

Always provide a full-term prior to first abbreviation.

Do NOT abbreviate terms you use less than three (3) times.
You **have to** be mindful of readability. Abbreviations are more useful if the abbreviated term is conventional (e.g., ANOVA) and if it *considerably* helps with repetition. Sometimes it is better to spell a term out each time than to use a confusing abbreviation.

APA publication manual, 7th edition, section 6.24

Overuse. Sometimes the space saved by using abbreviations is not justified by the time necessary for readers to master the meaning, as in the following example:

> The advantage of the LH was clear from the RT data, which reflected high FP and FN rates for the RH.

Without abbreviations, the previous passage reads as follows:

> The advantage of the left hand was clear from the reaction time data, which reflected high false-positive and false-negative rates for the right hand.

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General tips: Capitalization

Measures: capitalize titles, do not capitalize words like "scale" or "questionnaire" unless it is in the title

- Credibility of Science Scale

but

- Psychological Distance to Science scale

APA publication manual, 7th edition, section 6.18

Variables: do not capitalize them*, unless they appear with multiplication signs

- gender, age, trust variables

but

- Age x Trust interaction

** Special rules apply for factors derived from PCA, or factor analysis*

APA publication manual, 7th edition, section 6.21

Disorders, therapies, theories, etc.: not capitalized, only capitalize personal names if they are within the term

- autism spectrum disorder

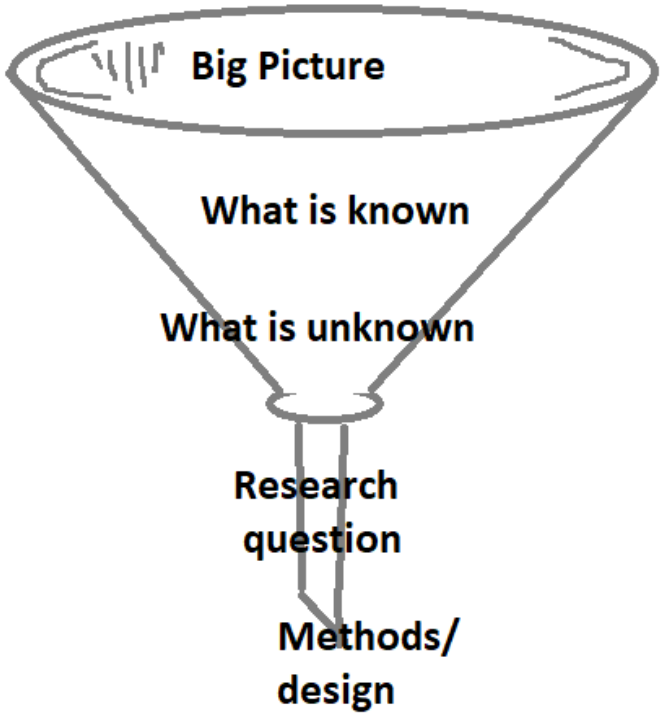
but

- Alzheimer's disease

APA publication manual, 7th edition, section 6.16

More rules in chapter 6, section Capitalization of the APA publication manual, 7th edition.

The Funnel



General → literature review → problem statement → your study

MYTH DEBUNKING

"Big" picture **does not** mean "big" (large) amount.

the big picture, broad, general statements are **the shortest** part

It is important to shift focus to your own study as soon as possible.

How to start... writing

Starting – often hardest part

What helps me :

1. Naming some points I want to/have to include
   - You can treat these like a question or just a bulletpoint
2. Finding articles that support each point
3. Organizing points so that they follow some kind of structure (such as the funnel)
4. Writing only when I have enough articles to complete a point

NB: These are some things I find useful, but it is up to you to find a system that works for you.

MY POINTS

- Why is trust in science important?
- How do I define trust in science?
- How do (my variable of interest) political beliefs affect people's trust in science?...

The points depend on RQ needs, the rubric and what I want to include.

ARTICLES

You can find them on Google Scholar, PsycINFO, Web of Science, PubMed...
Good to have 3-5 articles to support each of your own points, but more support = better. There is no rule for this.
I like to put the main finding of each article as a bulletpoint, together with a full citation.

How to start... the introduction

Engaging and informative!

Some options for an opening:

- Question
- Eye-catching statistic or fact (short first sentences can be powerful)
- Historical background
- Everyday experience
- Lack of previous research (research gap)
- Defining the topic of study
- Combination of the above.

FACT

Beliefs matter. Our beliefs can comfort us, provide us with meaning, or tie us more closely to others (Heine, Proulx, & Vohs, 2006; Hogg & Mulling, 1999; Lerner & Miller, 1978).

Farias et al. (2013)

STATISTIC

Trust in science among the public is generally quite high, as indicated by recent survey results showing that 90% of people across 17 countries (somewhat) agree with the statement "I trust science."

Većkalov et. al (2024)

DEFINITION

Scientific information constitutes a valuable resource for societies and individuals[1,2].

Druckman et. al (2025)

How to track references

You can do this manually, there are also websites that do this.

However – best option is using a **reference manager like Zotero**

zotero

If you use Zotero – you no longer have to have a million Google tabs open, or have a graveyard of badly named PDFs you cannot keep track of.

CLICK FOR TUTORIAL!



In Zotero:

- You can upload each paper's PDF, and it will automatically find the details
- You can search for papers through their DOI
- You can copy paste reference lists – so you never have to organize it yourself.

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Methods

You already have most of the necessary parts thanks to the proposal!

Some general tips:

- Write in **past tense**
- Include **enough**, but **not too much detail** (how many people participated, what was excluded, age range, mean, SD…)
- Important to include **scale reliability values and power analysis**
- You will not have all of the information needed immediately
  - **MAKE A TEMPLATE!** Write the methods as if you already have the data. Almost the entire method can be written prior to data collection.

> Hundred and ____ participants took part in this study. ___ participants did not complete all measures, bringing the final sample size to *N* = ___. There were ____ female , ____ male participants and ___ non-binary participants. ____ people indicated their gender as 'other'. The average age of those that participated was ___ (*SD* = __), ranging from ___ to ___.

  - You can also include some fake values if it is easier – just make sure to change them later.

Upcoming

Next Monday (October 12)	**Start data collection.** Each of you will get an individual link that tracks the # of people you recruited. We are recruiting 160 participants after all, not 200! Each of you must recruit **40**.
November 2 at 10:00	Submit introduction and methods.
November 6 at 14:00	Third group meeting.